94. Consider the following statements:

1. **Biodiversity hotspots are located only in tropical regions**
2. **Indian has four biodiversity hotspots i.e., Eastern Himalayas, Western Ghats and Andaman and Nicobar Islands.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (d) : Both the statements are incorrect. Currently, 36 biodiversity hotspots have been identified, most of which occur in tropical forests. They represent just 2.3% of Earth's land surface, but between them they contain around 50% of the world's endemic plant species and 42% of all terrestrial vertebrates. India hosts 4 biodiversity hotspots: the Himalayas, the Western Ghats, the Indo-Burma region and the Sundaland (Includes Nicobar group of Islands).

95. Consider the following statements:

1. **The boundaries of a National Park are defined by legislation.**
2. **A Biosphere Reserve is declared to conserve a few specific species of flora and fauna.**
3. **In a Wildlife Sanctuary, limited biotic interference is permitted.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c) : Biosphere Reserve declared forests means to conserve some representative ecosystems as a whole for long-term in situ. Since 1970, legislations like Wildlife Protection Act are used to specify borders of National Parks and Wildlife Sanctuary.

There are three zones in a wildlife sanctuary-core zone (no interference allowed), buffer zone (eco-development and forest improvement, regulated pilgrimage, research activities are allowed) and transition zone (tourism is allowed).

96. A pesticide which is a chlorinated hydrocarbon is sprayed on a food crop. The food chain is: Food crop-Rat-Snake-Hawk. In this food chain, the highest concentration of the pesticide would accumulate in which one of the following?

(a) Food crop (b) Rat
(c) Snake (d) Hawk

Ans. (d) : The correct answer is hawk.

Hawks are a group of medium-sized diurnal birds of prey of the family Accipitridae. Hawks are widely distributed and vary greatly in size. the subfamily Accipitrinae includes goshawks, sparrowhawks, sharp-shinned hawks and others. This subfamily are mainly woodland birds with long tails and high visual acuity.

97. With reference to soil conservation, consider the following practices:

1. **Crop rotation**
2. **Sand fences**
3. **Terracing**
4. **Wind breaks**

Which of the above are considered appropriate methods for soils conservation in India?

(a) 1, 2 and 3 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1, 3 and 4 only
(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (d) : Crop rotation, Sand fences, terracing and wind breaks all are used for sand conservation in India. Sand fences is a simple and cheap method of inducing accretion of sands in arid and sandy areas.

CURREN AFFAIRS

98. As per the UN-Habitat's Global Report on Human Settlements 2009, which one among the following regions has shown the fastest growth rate of urbanization in the last three decades?

(a) Asia
(b) Europe
(c) Latin America and Caribbean
(d) North America

Ans. (a)

- UN- Habitat's Global Report on Human Settlement 2009.
- According to the report, urban growth will be less rapid in developed regions, in Latin America and the Caribbean, and in transitional countries of East Europe, all of which are already highly urbanized, but rapid in Africa and Central, South and East Asia, which are currently less urbanized. China is expected to double its urban population from about 40% of its national population from 2006 to 2030 to more than 70% by 2050.
- The report points out the fact that urbanization in Asia is mainly due to the high level of mobility of the population from villages to the cities.
- The chart and the table are shown below will provide the global trends in urbanization:

The correct answer is Asia (a).

99 In the context of bilateral trade negotiations between India and European Union, what is the difference between European Commission and European Council?

1. **European Commission represents the EU in trade negotiations whereas European Council participates in the legislation of matters pertaining to economics policies of the European Union.**
2. **European Commission comprises the Heads of State or government of member countries where as the European Council comprises of the persons nominated by European Parliament.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (d) : The European Commission has four responsibilities that are central to the EU's operation; it proposes legislation designed to implement the objectives outlined in EU treaties, it manages EU policy and the EU budget, it acts as the guardian of the treaties, monitoring compliance with EU law and referring suspected cases of non-compliance to the Courts and it represents the EU in external trade negotiations. The European Council is the EU's supreme political body. The European Council brings together the political leaders of the member states. The President of the European Commission is also a member. It sets out general policy objectives for the EU to follow, deals with sensitive political matters and acts as a trouble shooter for areas of business where ministers are unable to agree.

100. With reference to the National Investment Fund to which the disinvestment proceeds are routed, consider the following statements:

1. **The assets in the National Investment Fund are managed by the Union Ministry of Finance.**
2. **The National Investment Fund is to be maintained within the Consolidated fund of the India.**
3. **Certain Asset Management Companies are appointed as the fund managers.**
4. **A certain proportion of annual income is used for financing select social sectors.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 only
(c) 3 and 4 (d) 3 only

Ans. (c) : Only 3 and 4 correct. So, the correct answer is (c).

Government of India had constituted the National Investment Fund (NIF) in November, 2005 into which the proceeds from disinvestment of Central Public Sector Enterprises were to be channelized. The corpus of NIF was to be of a permanent nature and NIF was to be professionally managed to provide sustainable returns to the Government, without depleting the corpus. Selected Public Sector Mutual Funds namely UTI Asset Management Company Ltd., SBI Funds Management Private Ltd. and LIC Mutual Fund Asset Management Company Ltd. were entrusted with the management of the NIF corpus. As per this Scheme, 75% of the annual income of the NIF was to be used for financing selected social sector schemes which promote education, health and employment. The residual 25% of the annual income of NIF was to be used to meet the capital investment requirements of profitable and revivable PSUs.

101. Consider the following statements:

1. **The Union Government fixes the Statutory Minimum Price of sugarcane for each sugar season.**
2. **Sugar and sugarcane are essential commodities under the Essential Commodities Act.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c) : Statutory minimum price of sugar come for every season is a policy provision while sugar and sugar cane falls within essential commodities act.

102. The International Development Association, a lending agency, is administered by the:

(a) International Bank for Reconstruction and Development
(b) International Fund for Agricultural Development
(c) United Nations Development Programme
(d) United Nations Industrial Development Organization

Ans. (a) : The International Development Association (IDA) is the part of the World Bank that helps the world's poorest countries. It is headquartered in Washington, D.C., United States. It was established in 1960. Together the IBRD and the IDA are called as the World Bank. The IBRD and IDA share the same staff and Headquarters and evaluate projects with the same rigorous standards.

103. With reference to the National Rehabilitation and Resettlement Policy, 2007 consider the following statements:

1. **This policy is applicable only to the persons affected by the acquisition of land for projects and not to the involuntary displacement due to any other reason.**
2. **This policy has been formulated by the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (d) : It has been formulated by ministry of rural development.

104. Two of the schemes launched by the Government of India for Women's development are Swadhar and Swayam Siddha. As regards the difference between them, consider the following statements: